Christianity it would itself become an intolerant pseudo-religion'.[244] (Is this what is happening in, for example, Poland and with the Christian Right in the United States?) Therefore, 'the decisive battle about the complexion of our civilisation – particularly a unifying Europe – will most likely take place *within liberalism itself*, between two models of liberalism […] namely, between the *pluralist model*, which seeks to create space for mutual respect and freedom for all (including in respect of religion), and the *universalist model*, which presents liberalism as a binding ideology.'[245] It is a battle that we, however, still yearn to see.

In any event, these examples explain some of the genuine concerns at the root of different types of populisms across Europe and Central Europe in particular. There, issues of migration, security, identity, governance, the economy, the urban-rural divide and also 'sexual democracy' have had their distinct imprint, characterised by the region's social history. As we saw in the first part of this book, Enlightenment ideas arrived with some delay in Central Europe, and the Austro-Hungarian Empire also kept the ideals of the French Revolution at bay. Its economic development was equally not generally conducive to a more liberal society. Finally, the Iron Curtain allowed for only limited spread of post-war philosophical and social trends in Europe, which also helped preserve social conservatism, seen in those times also as a silent opposition to the Communist system. Few classically liberal pockets of resistance survived, with some exceptions in the Czech Republic (with its liberal and industrial pre-war traditions) and in a couple of other large urban centres.

Moreover, the Communist regimes built a dense social network connecting businesses, administration, media and arts, which – with some difference from country to country – has to a large extent weathered the democratic changes in 1990s and can now be seen as a serious obstacle to economic and media pluralism, and to liberal democracy in general. In parallel, attempts to introduce liberal and in particular post-modern ideas after the democratic changes and Eastern Europe's return to Europe have not always gone down well in the region, especially when the agents of these ideological currents were seen as associated either with the remnants of the 'old guard' or with the nascent new elite or with copying of the West, as Holmes and Krastev suggested. As a result we have seen in Eastern Europe the rise of fundamentalist conservative and Christian ideology in a